

What kind of data can you use to create a 'PivotTable' report, and what do you need to do to prepare it? Once you've prepared the data, you can create the 'PivotTable' report by using the 'PivotTable' and 'PivotChart' Wizard. In the wizard, you'll actually choose the data source. (You can choose data already entered in Excel, or data from a database, called an 'external data source'.).

If you've chosen an external data source, the wizard lets you use a separate program called 'Microsoft Query' to connect to the data source and select just the data you want.

3.7.2.1 What Types Of Data You Can Use

- m Excel list or database
- m External data source: For example, you can use a database file, text file, or a source on the Internet. For more information about data sources, type 'types of databases' in the Office Assistant or on the 'Answer Wizard' tab in the Excel 'Help' window, and then click 'Search'.
- m Multiple consolidation ranges: You can combine and summarise data from several different Excel lists.
- m Another 'PivotTable' report: Do you plan to use the same data to create multiple 'PivotTable' reports? If so, you can save memory and disk space by reusing a copy of the data from an existing 'PivotTable' report to create a new 'PivotTable' report. This action permanently links both the original and new 'PivotTable' reports. (For example, if you refresh the data in the original 'PivotTable' report, the data in the new report is also refreshed, and vice-versa.)

3.7.2.2 What You Need To Do To Prepare The Data

3.7.2.2.1 Prepare data from an Excel List or Database

There are a few things to consider in preparing your Excel data:

- m Make sure the list is well organised: Neatness counts! For example, make sure the first row of the list contains column labels, since Excel will use this data for the field names in the report.